

■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Wednesday, August 12, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (3 stories)

■ **WHO pushes back on Trump's vaccine policy shift**

The Angle: The World Health Organization is calling out the incoming Trump administration over vaccine policy changes that contradict established health evidence—and US courts have already blocked parts of it once before. This is shaping up to be a major clash between the new White House and global health authorities.

- **US courts suspended Trump's vaccination policy shake-up earlier this year**
- The **WHO says the changes go against established evidence** on vaccine safety and efficacy
- This marks an early friction point between the Trump administration and international health institutions

The Hot Take

- Should a new US president be able to overhaul vaccine policy, or should that be locked down by medical evidence?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/news/world/who-says-trump-vaccine-shake-up-goes-against-evidence>

■■ **France's nuclear crisis: Heat and jellyfish shut down one-fifth of power**

The Angle: France, Europe's nuclear superpower, is struggling to keep the lights on as extreme heat waves and jellyfish blooms force reactor shutdowns. It's a wake-up call about climate change hitting energy security in real time.

- **One-fifth of France's nuclear capacity** is currently offline due to extreme weather
- Multiple **heatwaves and droughts** this year have disrupted nuclear power production across the country
- **Jellyfish blooms** have clogged cooling systems at some reactor sites, forcing emergency shutdowns

The Climate Irony

- France bet everything on nuclear to be climate-proof—so how does climate change end up being nuclear's biggest enemy right now?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/news/world/extreme-weather-jellyfish-knock-one-fifth-of-frances-nuclear-capacity-offline>

■ **Inflation Ticks Down—But the Fed Still Can't Agree**

The Angle: Inflation cooled slightly to 3.4% in July, giving some relief at the grocery store and gas pump. But it's still stubbornly above the Fed's 2% target, and that means interest rates—and your mortgage, car loan, and credit card bills—could stay stuck in limbo while policymakers debate what to do next.

- **Consumer Price Index rose 3.4%** in July year-over-year, down from **3.5% in June**, according to the **Bureau of Labor Statistics**
- The decline marks continued cooling from inflation peaks above **9%** in mid-2022
- The figure remains significantly above the **Federal Reserve's 2% target**, keeping rate-cut timing uncertain

The Wallet Check

- Are you actually **feeling** that inflation drop, or does it still hurt when you pay your bills?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

TRENDING TODAY

■ **Russia escalates attacks on Ukraine's fuel infrastructure**

***The Angle:** Russia is deliberately targeting petrol stations and energy supply lines as a strategic weapon to force civilians out of cities and cripple Ukraine's ability to move troops and supplies. It's part of a larger pattern of infrastructure warfare that's reshaping how this conflict is being fought.*

- **Russia has regularly targeted Ukraine's energy infrastructure** since the **2022 full-scale invasion**, including thermal power plants, gas distribution networks, and pipelines
- Petrol stations are now a **deliberate strategic target** designed to disrupt civilian life and force population displacement
- The attacks on fuel supply create cascading effects: **no gas for cars, no power for heating, no way to evacuate**

The Strategy Angle

- Is attacking civilian fuel supply a war crime, or just brutal military strategy? Text in where you think the line is.

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/news/world/to-make-the-civilians-leave-russia-pummels-ukraines-petrol-stations>

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ **Canada's new pandemic lab faces a funding and red-tape problem**

***The Angle:** Ottawa's got big plans for a cutting-edge disease lab, but health researchers are sounding the alarm—without real money and fewer staff, it could end up just another good idea on paper. It's a timely reality check on how governments handle biosecurity.*

- **Ottawa** is planning a **state-of-the-art lab** designed to detect and respond to emerging health threats
- Top health researchers cite **long-term funding gaps** as a major threat to the lab's success
- The effort is hampered by **recent staff cuts** and **bureaucratic red tape**, according to the research community

The Infrastructure Paradox

- We just saw what happens when pandemic prep fails—so why do governments keep green-lighting labs without the money or people to actually run them?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/health/countermeasures-lab-challenges-canada-9.7303331?cmp=rss>

Backup options:

■ **Love Is Blind is officially coming to Canada—casting is open**

***The Angle:** Netflix's wildly popular dating experiment is setting up shop north of the border, and Canadians are already having the conversation: would YOU do it? It's the kind of pop-culture moment that gets people thinking about their own dating lives and relationship fears.*

- **Netflix** announced **Love Is Blind** is launching a Canadian version
- The show is **now accepting applications** from interested Canadian singles
- The format has people get engaged **without seeing each other first**, then meet face-to-face for the first time at the altar

The Dare Question

- Would you actually do Love Is Blind—get engaged to a stranger sight unseen—or is that a hard pass?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Quick Poll** - First 60 seconds -> Hosts each give a snap yes/no on whether they'd apply, with one quick reason why or why not

- **Step 2: The Friend Tag Factor** - Next segment beat -> Hosts text/DM a friend live on air (or read prepared responses) asking if that friend would nominate them for the show—surface some real hesitations or hype

- **Step 3: Phone Lines Open** - Main call segment -> Take listener calls: Have you or would you apply? What's the dealbreaker—can you really marry someone you haven't seen?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/love-is-blind-canada-9.7303202?cmp=rss>

■ **Joshua Jackson's new romance just went public—literally**

The Angle: *The Dawson's Creek star and model Olivia Burgess stopped playing it cool and confirmed their relationship the old-fashioned way: a very public kiss in LA. It's the kind of celebrity couple confirmation that sparks immediate watercooler chatter.*

- **Joshua Jackson** and model **Olivia Burgess** confirmed their dating rumors with a **public makeout session** in Los Angeles
- The couple made their relationship official through the kiss during an LA date

The Relationship Thermometer

- How do you feel about celebrities confirming relationships this way—bold move or just asking for the paparazzi circus?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/08/11/celebrity-news/joshua-jackson-and-model-olivia-burgess-confirm-dating-rumors-with-steamy-makeout-session/>

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

(no candidate scored high enough today)

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ **'Spider-Man: Brand New Day,' 'The Odyssey' Battle Atop U.K., Ireland Box Office - Variety**

The Angle: *'Spider-Man: Brand New Day,' 'The Odyssey' Battle Atop U.K., Ireland Box Office - Variety*

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://variety.com/2026/film/box-office/spider-man-brand-new-day-the-odyssey-uk-ireland-box-office-1236831811/>

■■ **Manitoba mother demands answers after daughter dies in CFS care**

The Angle: *A four-year-old died while under the supervision of Child and Family Services in Manitoba, and two siblings were hospitalized with serious injuries—raising urgent questions about oversight failures and accountability in child welfare. This is the kind of systemic breakdown story that sparks real policy conversations.*

- A **four-year-old daughter** died while in the care of **Child and Family Services** in Manitoba

- The mother's **two other children** were taken to a **Winnipeg hospital** with **serious injuries**
- The mother says she was **actively trying to regain custody** of her children at the time
- The family is now demanding someone be **held accountable** for what happened

The Accountability Question

- When a child dies in state care, who's responsible—the caseworker, the agency, the system, or all of the above?
And what actually needs to change?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/manitoba/child-death-mother-cfs-rcmp-9.7303787?cmp=rss>

■ **Christian non-profit sues City of Moncton for stopping concert last summer**

The Angle: *Christian non-profit sues City of Moncton for stopping concert last summer*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/new-brunswick/sean-feucht-lawsuit-moncton-show-canceled-worship-event-9.7302986?cmp=rss>

■ **You can stream AI TV 24/7 on Roku now**

The Angle: *You can stream AI TV 24/7 on Roku now*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/ai-streaming-channel-roku-9.7303917?cmp=rss>

■ **Canada wants Trump's ambassador out—29,000 people are signing on**

The Angle: *A viral petition demanding the U.S. Ambassador be expelled is heading to Parliament this fall, signaling real tension between Ottawa and Washington as Trump's team settles in. It's a rare diplomatic pressure move that shows how hot Canada-U.S. relations have gotten.*

- Over **29,000 Canadians** have signed a petition calling for U.S. Ambassador **Pete Hoekstra** to be declared persona non grata and removed from Canada.
- The petition is set to be **presented to the House of Commons this fall**, making it an official parliamentary matter.
- The move reflects mounting friction between the Canadian government and the Trump administration on tariffs, trade, and other bilateral issues.

The Take-the-Temp Check

- Is kicking out an ambassador actually going to change anything, or is this just performative politics when relations are already this rocky?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/petition-ambassador-hoekstra-removed-from-canada-9.7303372?cmp=rss>

■ **Body of 13-year-old girl who fell from paddleboard recovered from B.C. lake**

The Angle: *Body of 13-year-old girl who fell from paddleboard recovered from B.C. lake*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/body-13-year-old-girl-recovered-cultus-lake-9.7303279?cmp=rss>

■ **How to deal with a passive-aggressive partner, according to therapists**

The Angle: *How to deal with a passive-aggressive partner, according to therapists*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/life/relationships/how-to-deal-with-a-passive-aggressive-partner-according-to-therapists>

■ **2026 FedEx St. Jude's Championship picks: PGA Tour best bets, odds, predictions for TPC Southwind**

The Angle: 2026 FedEx St. Jude's Championship picks: PGA Tour best bets, odds, predictions for TPC Southwind

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:

<https://nypost.com/2026/08/12/betting/2026-fedex-st-judes-championship-picks-pga-tour-best-bets-odds-predictions-for-tpc-southwind/>

■ **How Jon Voight reacted to son James Haven coming out as gay**

The Angle: How Jon Voight reacted to son James Haven coming out as gay

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/08/12/celebrity-news/how-jon-voight-reacted-to-son-james-haven-coming-out-as-gay/>

■■ **Primary night surprises shake up 2024 race across four states**

The Angle: Wisconsin, Minnesota, South Carolina, and Connecticut held primaries with some stunning upsets—including a Trump-endorsed candidate getting stomped in Minnesota and a veteran congressman losing his seat in Connecticut. These are the kind of results that reshape expectations heading into the general election.

- **Trump-endorsed candidate** decisively lost in **Minnesota** primary
- A **longtime congressman** in **Connecticut** was ousted by voters
- Primary results came out of **Wisconsin, Minnesota, South Carolina, and Connecticut** on the same night
- Results suggest the far left miscalculated voter appetite, particularly around issues like **Thanksgiving** (or culture-war messaging)

The Upset Breakdown

- Which upset shocked you more—a Trump pick getting crushed, or a veteran congressman losing his own primary?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/08/12/us-news/takeaways-from-primary-night-in-wisconsin-minnesota-south-carolina-and-connecticut/>

■ **Author Eric Metaxas takes aim at the Left's 'satanic communism'**

The Angle: Conservative author and commentator Eric Metaxas is out with a new book on the American Revolution, and he's using the platform to argue that the Founding Fathers would reject modern progressive ideology. It's the kind of culture-war red-meat that's been trending on the right side of social media.

- **Eric Metaxas** released a new book titled "**Revolution**" focused on heroism stories from the American Revolution
- Metaxas argues the **Founding Fathers would be ashamed** of what he calls the Left's adoption of Marxist ideology
- He contends that **Judeo-Christian values** are foundational to America's founding fabric

The Debate Starter

- Do the Founding Fathers' actual writings support Metaxas's take on what they'd think of today's politics—or is he reading modern culture wars backward into 1776?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/video/eric-metaxas-the-left-is-embracing-satanic-communism/>

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)

- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)
- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Here's How Louis Tomlinson Really Feels About These One Direction Songs on Band's 16-Year Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Guillermo del Toro said 'Absolutely No Goddamn AI' in 'Pan's Labyrinth' 3D Re-Release: 'We're Protecting a Lineage of Art'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Shop Oprah's 'favorites' at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale, from 'ultra-flattering' pants to skin care staples" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "'Star Trek: Starfleet Academy' Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
- "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror' Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC <https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o>" (X/Twitter @NYPPost, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Boy George Drops Out of 'Jesus Christ Superstar' After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)
- "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn't Invited to Partake in 'Wizards of Waverly Place' Revival: 'Disappointed'" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
- "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
- "Where to Watch 'Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th' Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
- "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
- "'Roseanne' Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)
- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)

Newly banked this run:

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @NYPost (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)

- @CTVNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (fetch failed)
- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- @Variety (fetch failed)
- 17 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-12 09:06 AM